

ENR 1.2 VISUAL FLIGHT RULES

1. General

- 1.1 Except as otherwise authorized by the appropriate air traffic control unit for VFR flights within control zones, VFR flights shall be conducted so that the aircraft is flown in conditions of visibility and distance from cloud equal to or greater than those specified in the following table:

	WITHIN CONTROLLED AIRSPACE		OUTSIDE CONTROLLED AIRSPACE	
	ABOVE	AT OR BELOW	ABOVE	AT OR BELOW
			900M (3,000FT) above mean sea level 300M (1,000FT) above terrain, whichever is higher.	
FLIGHT VISIBILITY	8KM above 3,050M (10,000FT) AMSL	5KM below 3,050M (10,000FT) AMSL	8KM above 3,050M (10,000FT) AMSL	5KM *
Distance from cloud:				
a) Horizontal	1,500M	1,500M	1,500M	Clear of cloud and in sight of the surface
b) Vertical	300M (1,000FT)	300M (1,000FT)	300M (1,000FT)	

* When so prescribed by the appropriate ATS authority:

- a) Lower flight visibilities to 1,500M may be permitted for flights operating:
 - i) At speeds that, in the prevailing visibility, will give adequate opportunity to observe other traffic or any obstacles in time to avoid collision; or
 - ii) In circumstances in which the probability of encounters with other traffic would normally be low, e.g. in areas of low volume traffic and for aerial work at low levels.
 - b) Helicopters may be permitted to operate in less than 1,500M flight visibility, if maneuvered at a speed that will give adequate opportunity to observe other traffic or any obstacle in time to avoid collision.
- 1.2 Except when a clearance is obtained from an air traffic control unit, VFR flights shall not take-off or land at an aerodrome within a control zone, or enter this aerodrome traffic zone or traffic pattern:
- a) When the ceiling is less than 450 meters (1,500 feet); or
 - b) When the ground visibility is less than 5KM (3 miles).
- 1.3 Unless authorized by the appropriate ATS authority, VFR flights shall not be operated:
- a) between sunset and sunrise, or such other period between sunset and sunrise as may be prescribed by the appropriate ATS authority.
 - b) above FL200.
 - c) at transonic and supersonic speeds.
- 1.4 Except when necessary for take-off or landing, or except by permission from the

appropriate authority, VFR flights shall not be flown:

- a) over the congested areas of the cities, towns or settlements or over an open-air assembly of persons at a height less than 300 meters (1,000 feet) above the highest obstacle within a radius of 600 meters (2,000 feet) from the aircraft;
 - b) elsewhere than as specified in 1.4 (a) at a height less than 150 meters (500 feet) above the ground or water.
- 1.5 Except as provided in 1.6, VFR flights in level cruising flight when operated above 900 meters (3,000 feet) from the ground or water, or a higher datum as specified by the appropriate ATS authority, shall be conducted at a flight level appropriate to the track as specified in Appendix 1 - Table of Cruising Levels for VFR Flights.
- 1.6 VFR flights operated in controlled airspace (instrument or visual) shall select cruising levels from those to be used by the IFR flights as specified in para. 2.2 of ENR 1.3 Instrument Flight Rules, except that the correlation of levels to track shall not apply whenever otherwise indicated in air traffic control clearances or specified by the appropriate ATS authority in the Aeronautical Information Publication.
- 1.7 VFR flights shall comply with the provisions of the air traffic control service:
- a) when forming part of aerodrome traffic at controlled aerodromes; or
 - b) when operated as special VFR flights; or
 - c) when operated in controlled airspace (instrument or visual).
- 1.8 A VFR flight operating outside controlled airspace (instrument or visual) but within or into areas, or along routes designated by the appropriate ATS authority in accordance with the requirements to submit a flight plan, shall maintain continuous listening watch on the appropriate radio frequency of, and report its position as necessary to the air traffic services unit providing flight information service.
- 1.9 All flights operating under VFR shall establish radio contact ten (10) minutes before the aircraft is estimated to reach the intended point of entry into a control area or advisory area or the point of crossing an airway or advisory route.
- 1.10 An aircraft operated in accordance with the visual flight rules which wishes to change to compliance with the instrument flight rules shall:
- a) if a flight plan was submitted, communicate the necessary changes to be effected to its current flight plan; or
 - b) when so required, submit a flight plan to the appropriate air traffic services unit and obtain a clearance prior to proceeding IFR when in controlled airspace.

2. Suspension of VFR Operations

- 2.1 Any or all VFR operations on and in the vicinity of an aerodrome may be suspended by any of the following units, persons or authorities whenever safety requires such action:
- a) the approach control unit or the appropriate ACC;
 - b) the aerodrome control tower;
 - c) the appropriate ATS authority.
- 2.2 All such suspensions of VFR operations shall be accomplished through or

notified to the aerodrome control tower.

- 2.3 The following procedures shall be observed by the aerodrome control tower whenever VFR operations are suspended:
- a) hold all VFR departures;
 - b) recall all local flights operating under VFR or obtain approval for special VFR operations;
 - c) notify the approach control unit or ACC as appropriate of the action taken;
 - d) notify all operators, or their designated representatives, of the reason for taking such action, if necessary or requested.

3. Authorization of Special VFR flights

- 3.1 When traffic conditions permit, special VFR flights may be authorized subject to the approval of the unit providing approach control service.
- 3.2 Requests for such authorization shall be handled individually.
- 3.3 Separation shall be effected between all IFR flights and special VFR flights in accordance with separation minima prescribed by the appropriate ATS authority, between all special VFR flights in accordance with separation minima prescribed by that authority.
- 3.4 When the ground visibility is not less than 1,500M, special VFR flights may be authorized to: enter a control zone for the purpose of landing, take off and depart from a control zone, cross a control zone or operate locally within a control zone.

APPENDIX 1 - TABLE OF CRUISING LEVELS FOR VFR FLIGHTS

TRACK					
From 000° to 179°			From 180° to 359°		
FL	ALTITUDE		FL	ALTITUDE	
	Meters	Feet		Meters	Feet
35	1,050	3,500	45	1,350	4,500
55	1,700	5,500	65	2,000	6,500
75	2,300	7,500	85	2,600	8,500
95	2,900	9,500	105	3,200	10,500
115	3,500	11,500	125	3,800	12,500
135	4,100	13,500	145	4,400	14,500
155	4,700	15,500	165	5,050	16,500
175	5,350	17,500	185	5,660	18,500
195	5,950	19,500			